PHISHING AAWARENESS TRAINING

By K.ARAVINDH

PHISHING AWARENESS

Protect Yourself from Online Scams

This training will help you understand how phishing works, how attackers trick users, and how you can stay safe in real-world situations.

WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a cyber attack where criminals pretend to be trusted organizations (banks, companies, government agencies) to steal sensitive information. They typically try to collect:

- Login credentials (usernames & passwords)
- Credit/debit card details
- Personal identity information

Phishing attacks rely more on human mistakes than technical hacking.

COMMON TYPES OF PHISHING

- Email Phishing – Mass emails sent to many users pretending to be legitimate
- Spear Phishing – Highly targeted attacks using personal information
- Smishing – Fake messages sent via SMS (e.g., OTP scams)
- Vishing – Fraudulent phone calls pretending to be support agents

Attackers choose methods based on what’s easiest to trick you.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE PHISHING EMAILS

Carefully examine emails before trusting them:

- Check the sender's email (e.g., support@paypa1.com instead of paypal.com)
- Look for generic greetings like "Dear Customer"
- Watch for urgent language pressuring you to act quickly
- Be cautious of unexpected attachments or links
- Notice poor spelling, grammar, or formatting

Always think: "Is this message trying to rush or scare me?"

EXAMPLE OF A PHISHING EMAIL

Subject: Urgent: Account Suspension Notice
"Your account will be suspended within 24 hours unless you verify your details immediately. Click the link below to secure your account."
⚠ Red Flags:

- Creates panic (urgency)
- Suspicious link (may lead to fake website)
- Requests sensitive information

Tip: Hover over links to preview the real URL before clicking.

RECOGNIZING FAKE WEBSITES

Fake websites are designed to look real but steal your data.

How to identify them:

- Check for HTTPS (but don’t rely only on it)
- Look closely at the domain name (e.g., amaz0n.com)
- Poor design or broken elements
- Unusual pop-ups asking for sensitive info
- Lack of proper contact or support information

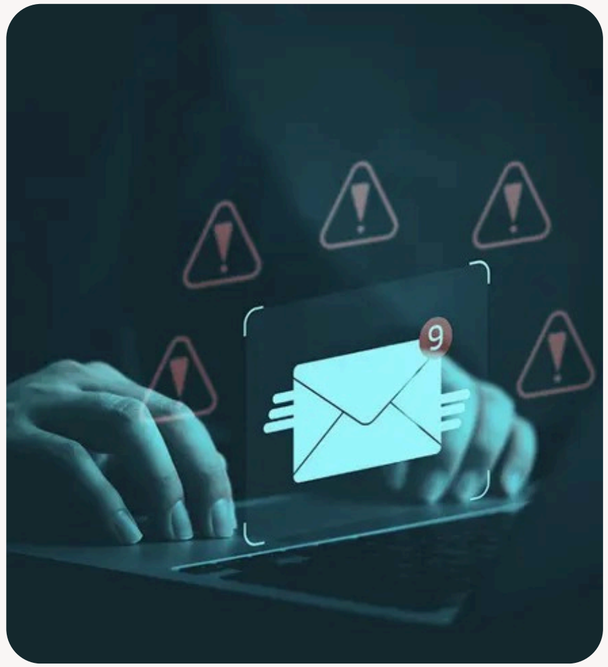
When in doubt, manually type the official website URL.

SOCIAL ENGINEERING TACTICS

Phishing attacks use psychological tricks:

- Fear: “Your account will be locked”
- Urgency: “Act now or lose access”
- Authority: Pretending to be bank/HR/admin
- Curiosity: “You’ve won a prize”
- Greed: “Claim your reward”

These tactics are designed to make you react without thinking.



REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

During COVID-19, attackers sent emails pretending to be from WHO and health organizations.

They included:

- Fake safety guidelines
- Malicious links
- Requests for login credentials

Impact:

- Thousands of users lost personal and financial data

Lesson: Always verify the source, even if it looks official.

BEST PRACTICES TO STAY SAFE

Follow these habits daily:

- Never click unknown or suspicious links
- Verify emails by contacting the organization directly
- Use strong and unique passwords for each account
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Keep your system and apps updated
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions

Security is a habit, not a one-time action.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU SUSPECT PHISHING

Take immediate action:

- Do NOT click links or download attachments
- Report the email to IT or security team
- Mark the email as spam/phishing
- Delete the message
- Change your passwords if you interacted with it

Quick reporting can prevent larger attacks.

QUICK QUIZ

Q1: Which is a common phishing sign?

- A. Friendly tone
- B. Urgent request for action
- C. Known sender name

Q2: What should you do with suspicious links?

A. Click to verify

B. Ignore and report

C. Forward to others

Q3: What is spear phishing?

- A. Random attack
- B. Targeted attack
- C. Phone scam

ANSWERS

Q1: B

Q2: B

Q3: B

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Think before you click
- Always verify the sender and links
- Do not share sensitive information easily
- Report suspicious activity immediately

Your awareness is the first line of defense.

THANK YOU